

Element B

High schools are working to provide mind games and cozy, relaxing areas for students to decompress. School is a stressful environment where some students may feel unsafe, anxious, and need a way to decompress when it is appropriate.

A high school in Greenbelt, Maryland provided a PS5 for the library alongside other games for students to use. This solution was unsuccessful as very few students actually know about it and use it. It isn't known about and doesn't work well for student usage. This wastes the money and time spent on it and is overall an unsuccessful idea. It didn't grab attention well or fit well with what students want. Other solutions throughout many high schools include having brain challenging games such as puzzles and typical board games. These games are familiar to students and therefore grab their attention and work to provide a calming option throughout the school day.

Prior or present solution #1

Tactile engagement boards

A designed "wall" for students to relax by having different fidgets and textures to mess with. This works as a solution to the variety of options needed to be given to students as an option of relaxation and separation from the typical stressful environment. The design works and is practical. A design described in a particular article describes, "A successful object board starts with a stable, adaptable base and accessible positioning." (Carmen; 2025)

Prior or present solution #2

RecRe Lockers

Automated, self-service rental lockers for campuses. Students use them to scan and then borrow items to aid in education, or in this related case - games such as chess, jenga, and so on.

Prior or present solution #3

Physical board game integration

High schools provide a variety of well known, classic board games like mancala, monopoly, uno, and much more. These grab student's attention and provide an option to take their mind off of stress and work their brain.

Object Awareness. (2024). Teaching Students with Visual Impairments.

<https://www.teachingvisuallyimpaired.com/interactive-object-boards.html>

How it Works. (2025, December). RecRe. <https://recrebox.com/how-it-works/>